

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 4
 ♥ K J 8 6 2
 ♦ K Q 5
 ♣ K 10 7 3

♠ A K Q 10 9 7

♥ A 5

♦ 7 3

♣ A Q 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 5 2

♥ 10 9 3

♦ J 10 9 4

♣ J 8 2

♠ 8 6 3

♥ Q 7 4

♦ A 8 6 2

♣ 9 5 4

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♠
Dbl	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			

You have a good hand, a very good hand. But not good enough to open 2 ♣.

Instead you open 1 ♠, partner raises to 2 ♠ and West doubles.

Some would think it clever to now redouble - to put the pressure on West maybe.

But why bother? West would just bid 3 ♥ or 3 ♦ and then you would bid 4 ♠. So save all the in-between and just bid it now.

North plays 4 ♠. East leads the ♦ J.

North plays 4 ♠. East leads the ♦ J.

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 2 : Total = 4

One loser to get rid of. Perhaps you could lead toward the ♥ Q? Nope, that wouldn't work because West surely has the ♥ K for his Takeout Double.

Play West for the ♣ K and finesse him out of it? That probably would work since he likely has that card for his Takeout Double.

So you take the ♦ A, pull trumps and then . . . and then you apologize to your partner. You had to be in dummy to finesse the ♣ and you were only going to be there once. You must finesse the ♣ immediately, then pull trumps.

You are only going to be in dummy that one time so you must make sure to do whatever you need to do right then.

If you decided to play for trumps to split 2-2 so you could use the ♠ 8 as an entry back to dummy for the ♣ finesse then you need to start thinking more clearly!

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 8 4
♥ 9 7
♦ A 9 4
♣ Q J 10 5 3

♠ J 10 7

♥ A Q J 4

♦ 7 6 5 2

♣ 9 7



♠ 2

♥ 10 8 5 3

♦ Q J 10 3

♣ K 6 4 2

♠ A Q 9 6 5 3

♥ K 6 2

♦ K 8

♣ A 8

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	3 ♥
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			

4 ♠ by South

and then try the ♠ finesse. Your big worry should be that if the ♠ finesse loses East will be able to get the lead and play a ♦ through your ♦ K 8.

So ask yourself: "How is East going to get the lead?" The only trick he could win would be the ♣K which he almost surely has. But you can keep this from happening by simply holding up on the first ♣ trick. Win the next one with your ♣A, enter dummy with a ♥ and take the ♠ finesse. It loses, but to West who can't hurt you with a ♦ play.

Recognize that East is the Danger Hand because he can lead a ♦.

Then think about how to keep East from getting the lead - in this case holding up on the first trick.

You open 1 ♠ and partner responds 2 ♠.

With 18 points you want to invite partner to bid game if he has 9 or 10 points. While you could do this with a 3 ♠ bid it is more informative to use a Help Suit Game try - bidding 3 of the suit you'd most like help in. You bid 3 ♥.

Partner has magnificent help in the ♥ suit so he bids 4 ♠.

South to play 4 ♠. West leads the ♣Q.

South to play 4 ♠. West leads the ♣Q. East plays ♣6.

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 1 : Total = 4

You know you are going to get to dummy with a ♥

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 5
♥ 9 6 5
♦ 10 7 6 2
♣ A 10 8 4

♠ Q 10 9 7 4 3

♥ A 8 2

♦ K Q 8

♣ 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8

♥ Q J 10 4

♦ A 9 5 3

♣ Q J 9 5

♠ K J 6 2

♥ K 7 3

♦ J 4

♣ K 7 6 2

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

Pass

3 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by North

your "slow" ♥ loser. There are two possibilities, but each must be tried immediately because once you lose the lead the defenders will set up their ♥.

You could win the ♥ in your hand and lead toward the ♣K. If East holds ♣A you can establish the ♣K for a ♥ discard.

You could win in dummy and set up a ♦ no matter which defender holds ♦A. You could then discard a ♥ from dummy on your good ♦. This is obviously the better choice since it works with any distribution.

Win the first trick with dummy's ♥K and play ♦J. Continue ♦s until they take the ♦A. Win their return with your ♥A and discard dummy's ♥7 on your good ♦. Only then do you start on trumps.

It was wise to choose to set up your ♦ rather than dummy's ♣K because the ♦ play did not depend on a fortunate placement of the cards.

A very important part of this Plan was where you chose to win the first trick. Since entries are a problem with either hand you had to save the high ♥ as entry to the hand that would have the eventual winner.

With four trumps and 11-12 points you have a pretty standard limit raise.

So you bid 3 ♠ and partner raises to game.

South would play 4 ♠.

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North plays 4 ♠. East leads the ♥Q.

North plays 4 ♠. East leads the ♥Q.

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 1 : Total = 4

You have a loser in each suit and must eliminate one of them. Since the defense can take their Aces whenever they want to you need to find a place to put